

How to Solve

Each puzzle is a real line from a classic Christmas story, written in code. Every letter has been swapped for a different letter, and the same swap is used all the way through that puzzle.

The hint tells you where to start. "Hint: Q = E" means every coded Q in that puzzle is really the letter E. Write the real letters on the lines above the coded ones. Spaces and punctuation are not coded, so they are free clues.

Under each puzzle is a letter tracker. Each box sits under a coded letter; write in what it stands for as you work it out, and the tracker keeps your answers straight.

Tips

One-letter words are almost always A or I. Common three-letter words are THE and AND. No letter ever stands for itself, and every puzzle has its own code.

The puzzles get harder as you go, with fewer hints and trickier quotes. Answers are at the back.

Example

Hint: S = R D = Y

 N W I S S D A C S Q P G W N P G E

 I K I S D L E X D

from Charles Dickens, A Christmas Carol (1843)

A B C D E F G H I J K L M N O P Q R S T U V W X Y Z
 □ □ □ Y □ □ □ □ □ □ □ □ □ □ □ □ □ R □ □ □ □ □ □ □

Answer: A merry Christmas to everybody!

#1 EASY

Hint: $R = E$ $W = M$ $H = S$

P E M W E S H F P J U S E S H E
O R E S U R M , P E M W E S H
U E A A B E S H E C E C J R F , P
E M W E S H W E R M M B E S H E
S H T U N N F D N B .

from Charles Dickens, *A Christmas Carol* (1843)

A	B	C	D	E	F	G	H	I	J	K	L	M	N	O	P	Q	R	S	T	U	V	W	X	Y	Z
							S										E					M			

SCRATCH PAD

#2 EASY

Hint: $F = A$ $O = E$ $G = W$

<u>L</u>	<u>M</u>	<u>Z</u>		<u>Q</u>	<u>V</u>	<u>A</u> <u>F</u>	<u>U</u>	<u>A</u> <u>F</u>	<u>E</u>	<u>Z</u>	<u>W</u> <u>G</u>	<u>S</u>	<u>P</u>	<u>J</u>	
<u>Z</u>	<u>S</u>		<u>Z</u>	<u>K</u>	<u>E</u> <u>O</u>	<u>W</u> <u>G</u>	<u>Q</u>	<u>E</u>	<u>O</u>	<u>S</u>	<u>W</u>	<u>Z</u>	<u>K</u>	<u>E</u> <u>O</u>	<u>E</u> <u>O</u>
<u>J</u>	<u>A</u> <u>F</u>	<u>I</u>	<u>E</u>		<u>E</u> <u>O</u>	<u>Z</u>	<u>Q</u>	<u>Z</u>		<u>E</u> <u>O</u>		<u>A</u> <u>E</u>	<u>F</u>	<u>Q</u>	<u>J</u>
<u>Z</u>	<u>K</u>	<u>A</u> <u>F</u>	<u>Z</u>	<u>S</u>	<u>W</u>	<u>A</u> <u>F</u>	<u>U</u>	<u>U</u>	<u>W</u> <u>G</u>	<u>K</u>	<u>S</u>		<u>N</u>	<u>Q</u>	<u>D</u> <u>O</u>
<u>N</u>	<u>Q</u>	<u>W</u>	<u>Z</u>	<u>E</u>		<u>E</u> <u>O</u>	<u>Z</u>	<u>E</u> <u>O</u>		<u>W</u> <u>Z</u>	<u>G</u>	<u>S</u>	<u>W</u> <u>G</u>	<u>E</u> <u>O</u>	<u>E</u> <u>O</u>
<u>Z</u>	<u>K</u>	<u>E</u> <u>O</u>		<u>W</u> <u>G</u>	<u>Q</u>	<u>E</u> <u>O</u>	<u>E</u> <u>O</u>	<u>Z</u>	.						

from O. Henry, *The Gift of the Magi* (1905)

[illegible]

SCRATCH PAD

#3 EASY

Hint: $H = O$ $M = R$ $E = T$

 ,
D H M E N L V B F T R T E

K F B F B N F J L E H

Z S F M M L Y S Q H U

 .
W N M T B E J F B R F V F U R

 !
B H T E K F B A H R Y H O L

 , !
T E B H T E K F B

from Charles Dickens, *A Christmas Carol* (1843)

[illegible]

SCRATCH PAD

Enjoyed these?

These pages are a free sample from
Christmas Cryptograms: Large Print

The full book has 170 festive quotes to decode,
easy to hard, with large-print answers.
Find it on Amazon by searching the title, or use the link
on the page where you found this sample.